

Dhruv Kothari

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MS Finance Candidate · CFA Level 1 Candidate · Portfolio Management & Wealth Management

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Finance

2025 – 2026

W.P. Carey School of Business, Arizona State University | GPA: 3.66/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Investment Management, Fixed Income, Quantitative Methods, Accountancy, Managerial Finance, Risk Management, Entrepreneurial Finance

Bachelor of Business Administration

May 2024

St. Joseph's College (Autonomous), Bengaluru | GPA: 3.45/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Financial Modelling & Valuation, Securities Analysis & Portfolio Management, Financial & Commodity Markets, Corporate Accounting, Financial Management, Accountancy & Taxation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Finance & Operations Intern | Embassy Group, Bengaluru

Sep 2024 – Mar 2025

- Supported budgeting, forecasting, and ad hoc financial analysis for an \$11M+ IT operating budget, reviewing growth projections, variance analysis, and identifying industry cost drivers.
- Built a centralized Customer Data Platform integrating financial data from 250 internal sources, reducing manual reporting by 50% and improving data-driven decision-making for leadership.
- Designed and implemented a Procure-to-Pay cycle in Zoho Creator, reducing process inefficiencies by 30% and improving spend visibility across the organization.
- Collaborated with the CTO on strategic research initiatives, developing cross-functional communication and presentation skills for senior stakeholder audiences.

Finance Intern | Micro Labs Ltd., Bengaluru

Feb 2023 – Mar 2023

- Contributed to weekly financial reports reviewed by senior leadership, summarizing key financial and operational metrics to support timely executive decisions.
- Assisted the CFO in reviewing resource utilization and financial performance across \$12M+ in annual operating costs, supporting data-driven planning.

FINANCE PROJECTS

Equity Valuation & DCF Analysis – Johnson & Johnson (JNJ)

- Performed a full DCF valuation using a 5.8% WACC and 2.0% terminal growth rate, arriving at an intrinsic value of \$224/share (27% upside) and issuing a formal Buy recommendation.
- Built and stress-tested a multi-scenario financial model, presenting findings to faculty and peers in a team-based equity analysis format.

Portfolio Construction & Factor Modeling (Python)

- Implemented CAPM and Fama-French 5-Factor models across 20+ years of monthly equity data to estimate risk exposures, evaluate portfolio performance, and assess cross-sectional return behavior.
- Built 49 value-weighted industry portfolios and applied PCA to identify diversification drivers and factor-driven return predictability.

Research: Budgetary Controls & Organizational Performance

- Analyzed financial data from 10+ organizations, finding a strong positive correlation ($r = 0.62$) between effective budgeting and financial outcomes; presented findings at the International Virtual Conference, Dyal Singh College (April 2023).

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Member (Incoming) | Masters SIM Fund, ASU W.P. Carey School of Business

Fall 2026

- Selected to manage a portion of ASU's actively managed equity portfolio, conducting equity research and contributing to portfolio construction and investment decision-making.

CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

- CFA Level 1 Candidate
- National Cadet Corps 'C' Certificate (Mar 2022)

TECHNICAL & FINANCE SKILLS

Finance: Financial Modeling, DCF Valuation, Portfolio Analysis, Variance Analysis, Budgeting & Forecasting, Factor Models (CAPM, Fama-French), Data Visualization

Tools: MS Excel (VBA, Macros, PivotTables, VLOOKUP), PowerPoint, Tableau, Python, SQL, Zoho Creator, CRM tools

Languages: English (fluent), Hindi (fluent), Kannada (conversational)